

FLOW IMPROVEMENT PRIORITY LEGEND

Use this as a starting map. The goal is to remove the biggest flow losses first - not attack everything at once.

BABY-STEP RULE

Pick only 1-2 priorities at a time. Standardize the fix, let the shop absorb it, watch the result for 2-4 weeks, then choose the next one.

1A - START HERE

VERY HIGH

Purchased component shortages

Nuts, bolts, weld nuts, hinges, fasteners, or other purchased components are missing when welding is ready - or only the exact job quantity was ordered.

Why first: one missing low-cost component can stop an entire job and trigger emergency purchasing or freight.

1B - START HERE

VERY HIGH

Missing internally produced parts

Laser, forming, machining, or another operation sends too few good parts to welding. A scrap, bad bend, missed part, or damaged piece leaves the job short.

Why first: welding can be completely ready and still be forced to stop.

2 - NEXT

HIGH

Upstream condition / hidden work

Dross, burrs, scratches, wrong bends, fit-up problems, Porta-Vibe, deburring, grinding, cleaning, sorting, or other work arrives at welding that is not shown in the routing.

Why next: this creates invisible labor and makes welding time look worse than the real process.

3 - STABILIZE

HIGH

First-piece and sign-off gaps

Required first-piece checks or sign-offs from laser, forming, machining, or other operations are blank, skipped, or unclear.

Why: bad work moves farther downstream and becomes more expensive to correct.

4 - TRACK

MED-HIGH

Print clarity / missing information

Unreadable scale, missing finish class, unclear weld symbols, customer-print deficiencies, or print-to-part mismatch.

Track first: customer prints and limited engineering capacity make this harder to fix all at once. Separate internal fixes from customer-controlled issues.

ROLL-OUT: Find -> Rank -> Fix 1-2 -> Standardize -> Watch -> Measure -> Repeat

Fixing two of ten problems is progress. Removing a major constraint may expose a new one; that means the process is becoming clearer, not that the improvement failed.